SESSION 3 PREP - "The Flesh of Gamma-7"

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1. CONTINUITY SNAPSHOT & PARTY STATE

Last updated: 2026-08-31
Source: Session 2 completed. Events: 11-wolf siege at abandoned homestead. All wolves killed. Crystal extraction RP.

Party State

Stat	Value
Level	**4** - leveled up at the homestead after the wolf fight
Present	Zan, Aurora, Bardolemeu, Kaelyn, Balor, Nyra
Absent	Aegon (departed overnight - see Cold Open), Odessa (still away), Sanzo (still away)
HP	Fully recovered after long rest
Rest	Long rest complete at the homestead
FX Provisions	Potions of Healing (3), antitoxin, torches, tinderbox, bedrolls, 2x tents, rope, signal whistle, sending stone, map case
Healing waterskins (7)	Fully expired now - "just water with a memory." The glow has faded entirely.
Gold	Intact (no purses stolen in Session 2)

Active Conditions

- **Kaelyn, Zan, Balor** - bitten by crystal wolves. Lycanthropy incubation begun. Full moon in ~**4 days**.
- **Kaelyn** - wild magic surge at arcane-reactive crystal residue (Session 2). Tracks with her unstable magic condition.
- **Aegon** - Aurelius spoke to him: crystals are not divine, unknown arcane signature, dangerous, must be destroyed. Now Aegon has left to seek answers.

Homestead Loot (Still Available at Session Start)

- **4th crystal-wolf body** - untouched since the fight. Skull shard still intact. The party can extract it before departing (DC 15 Medicine, 10 min). Remind them on the cold open.

Open Threads Going Into Session 3

- What lies inside Site Gamma-7?
- Lycanthropy timer - full moon in ~4 days. PCs may need to resolve this before or during Gamma-7.
- Standing stones - not yet visited. Marked on FX's map as a landmark before Gamma-7.

- Wolf hideout (NW, ~1 hr) - stash mound, shackle-band clue, injured wolves - still in canon if party doubles back.

Timeline Pressure (table reference)

- **Monster army pushback:** 3 days remaining. Use as a pressure tool if they dawdle.

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2. COLD OPEN - "The Morning After"

Setting: Abandoned homestead. Dawn. Grey light through broken roof beams. The fire is cold ash. Eleven wolf bodies lie in the clearing where they fell.

Recap - facts to convey:

- 11 wolves attacked silently at ~2-3 AM - 4 crystal-grown skulls, 7 gaunt starving
- Party fought through the night, killed all 11
- Level up to 4 after the fight
- 3 crystal-wolf skull shards extracted (Aegon and Bardolemeu succeeded; Nyra's shattered)
- Healing waterskins: glow gone, inert - just water now
- Long rest complete. Fully healed. Ready to move.

Aegon's Absence - Discovery Beat

Setup: First to rise notices Aegon's bedroll empty, cold - gone for hours. His gear, armor, weapons all missing.

The note (what players find on his bedroll, weighted with a stone):

- He left before dawn
- Wants to investigate the crystal further, before proceeding
- He'll find them when he can

Before departure, give the party a moment to:

- **Extract the 4th skull shard** - if they don't remember, prompt with relevant info: one wolf body remains untouched, skull crest still intact, dawn light catching it
- **FX's map** shows the route:
  - **Day 3 - morning** - Head west through frontier grasslands. Reach a circle of standing stones on a ridge
  - **Day 3 - afternoon** - Gamma-7

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3. TRAVEL DAY - Homestead to Standing Stones

Terrain: Open frontier grasslands, transitioning from cultivated land (farms, fences, irrigation ditches - all abandoned) to wild prairie

Atmosphere - facts to convey:

- Quieter the further west - no birdsong by afternoon
- Tall brown grass rustling, old fence posts leaning (no wire)

- Lonely farmhouse chimney standing - rest collapsed long ago
- Ashen-gray sky - smoke from frontier fight and corpses burning
- Once-settled land being reclaimed by wild frontier

Travel pace: Normal or slow. If they rush (fast pace), they arrive at the standing stones area by nightfall but are exhausted. Slow pace means they make camp on the prairie and reach the stones mid-morning Day 2.

Roll d8 once during morning travel

Part A: Standing Stones (Morning to Midday)

Arrival facts to convey:

- Ridge-top: nine moss-covered stones in a circle
- Carvings: life -> death -> rebirth patterns
- Low altar with a rain-basin catching morning light
- Water impossibly clear - no debris, no algae despite years exposed

Investigation:

DC	Check	Result
12	Nature/Religion	Funerary rite site. Pre-dates all known religions. Not consecrated to any god. Safe.
15	Perception/Investigation	Beneath the altar, nestled in a dry recess: **3 bone tokens** (skull, leaf, star). Taking one marks the bearer for a boon.

Boon: Any PC who takes a token and offers something symbolically (a lock of hair, a memory spoken aloud, a drop of blood) gains: - reroll any one d20 before next dawn (keep the new result).

Part B: Gamma-7 Arrival (Late Afternoon)

Arrival facts - convey from the ridge:

- Valley below: collapsed dome center (stone ribs clawing sky)
- Broken tower snapped at half-height, leaning east
- No smoke, no movement, no sound
- Earth that's been disturbed in a circular pattern, campfire, waste - signs of someone having been in the area recently

Exterior - approach facts (as party descends from ridge):

- Perimeter wall: waist-high in most places, crumbled stone with rusted iron spikes every 10 ft
- Main gate: double iron doors, one hanging from a single hinge, the other propped open - forced entry, not decay
- Facility exterior: grey stone darkened by weather, ViF symbol in golden detail carved into an intact, large, black marble stone door
- Grounds: overgrown courtyard with a rusted well, an overturned wagon (wheels missing, salvage picked clean), and the skeletal remains of a horse in harness

Zan's recognition (private):

- He's never been here, but the layout is familiar. And the Three Curves - he saw them on a door in the facility where he was held. A restricted wing
- Proportions, single-axis centering: Flesh Architects design
- An outpost - smaller version of the facility he escaped
- Someone from the Flesh Architects built this

Roll d8 once during afternoon 2 travel

FX's Sending Stone Check-In

FX gave the party a **sending stone** back in Stonefall. It has been silent so far. Use these moments as scripted check-ins or if the party needs a nudge:

Scripted check-in (before entering Gamma-7, as they approach the exterior): The stone warms against a belt pouch or pack. A single sentence from FX, clipped and quiet: "*I've got movement near your position. Thormvuld scouts, maybe. Stay sharp. Contact me when you're inside.*" This reminds the party they have the stone, establishes FX is watching, and adds pressure.

Nudge check-in (if party is stuck, exploring without direction): The stone pulses twice — FX's signal. When activated: "*Found something in the old Thormvuld files. That symbol? Three Curves. It's on every document connected to your site. Be careful what you touch down there.*" This reveals FX is researching in parallel and gives the party a sense of active support.

Post-Gamma-7 (after they exit, regardless of outcome): FX checks in: "*You're alive. Good. Get clear of the area — Thormvuld will have riders heading that way. We'll debrief in Stonefall.*"

7. GAMMA-7 - INTERIOR

7.1 Entrance Options

Method	Skill Check	DC	Time	Notes
A. Collapsed Dome (Climb in)	Athletics	13	10 min	Climb through rubble where the dome roof caved in. Leads to **Room 1 - Main Hall**. Potential hazard: loose stone may shift (DEX save DC 10 or take 1d4 bludgeoning + alert anything inside).
B. Hidden Mechanism (Primary - Intact Door + Symbol Recognition)	Investigation	12	2 min	**The main door is intact and closed - the only intact entrance.** The ViF symbol on its face has one curve deliberately defaced (chisel marks) - Zan recognizes the **broken B curve**. Pressing the defaced curve opens the door silently. Requires one PC to press and hold the curve while another turns the handle. This is the intended method - the broken B is the key.
C. Underground Passage	Perception (find) +	14 /	30 min	Drainage tunnel entrance hidden behind overgrown brush. Partially collapsed - DC 12

Method	Skill Check	DC	Time	Notes
(Collapsed)	Athletics (clear)	12		Strength (Athletics) to clear rubble wide enough for Medium creatures. Leads to **Room 6 - Burn Pit / Waste Disposal** (back entrance to underground level).

GM Note (Method B): When Zan examines the door symbol, give him the spotlight. Relevant facts to convey - he's studied every detail of the Flesh Architects' facilities, but this Three Curves symbol is new. One curve broken. Someone deliberately defaced that specific curve. When he touches the defaced section, he feels it depress slightly - a mechanism. The Architects built this place for someone else, and Zan just found the evidence.

7.2 Facility Overview

Two levels:

- **Surface Level** (Room 1 only) - Former research area. Partial collapse from the dome
- **Underground Level** (Rooms 2 - 6) - Operational areas. Better preserved. No natural light.

Facility atmosphere - facts to convey:

- Dead, cold, still air
- Air is dry, tastes of old dust
- **Three Curves (ViF)** on every doorframe, document, equipment tag - often alongside the Flesh Architects' own lab crest

7.3 Surface Level

Room 1 - Main Hall (Collapsed Dome)

Description - facts to convey:

- Central chamber, dome collapsed inward - jagged opening to grey sky
- Rubble pile at center
- Rusted operating tables pushed against walls
- Shattered glass cabinets
- Large faded **Three Curves (ViF)** on the far wall

Investigation:

DC	Check	Result
10	Perception	Footprints in the dust - old, months to years. Several sets. Different sizes.
13	Investigation	Among the rubble: broken vials, a crushed microscope, fragments of glass slides labeled with specimen numbers. The slides are too damaged to read fully, but the prefix "MON-" appears on several.

DC	Check	Result
15	Medicine/Arcana	The operating tables show signs of use - restraint anchor points, dried biological residue in the seams. This was a procedure room. Not human subjects - the table dimensions are wrong. Too long, too narrow. Monster subjects.

Contents: Nothing of immediate value. The equipment is too damaged or rusted to salvage

Zan's observation (private):

- These operating tables are wrong - not built for humanoids
- The facility he escaped had similar theaters, but those fit human bodies
- These dimensions: too long, too narrow - built for creatures with four legs, or too many limbs
- Whatever was operated on here wasn't humanoid

Map Layout:

- **Size:** 8x8 squares (40x40 ft), octagonal/circular dome chamber
- **Entry points:**
  - ☐ Collapsed dome opening in ceiling - Athletics DC 13 to climb in/out, 10 min.
  - ☐ Main entrance door (Method B - hidden mechanism) in south wall
  - ☐ Spiral staircase behind false bookcase in north wall (DC 12 Perception to find) - descends to underground level.
- **Items to draw:**
  - ☐ Collapsed dome center (remove center 4x4, difficult terrain rubble)
  - ☐ 3 rusted operating tables against walls
  - ☐ 2 shattered glass cabinets
  - ☐ Large faded ViF Three Curves symbol on north wall above false bookcase
  - ☐ Footprints in dust (scattered).
- **Lighting:** Daylight from dome opening during day, dim shadows around edges

7.4 Underground Level

Underground Level Layout (Reference Map):

- **Spiral staircase** from Room 1 descends 30 ft, landing in a **narrow corridor** between Rooms 2 and 3
- **Corridor:** 2 squares wide (10 ft), runs ~16 squares (80 ft) southward. Stone walls, dust floor.
- Room access (southward from stairs landing):
  - West wall (immediately south of stairs): Door to **Room 2** (Guardian Beast Lair)
  - East wall: Corridor continues south past doors to Rooms 3, 4
  - Corridor dead-ends at **Room 6** (Burn Pit) at far south end
- Back entrance: Method C (collapsed drainage tunnel) opens into Room 6

Resting in Gamma-7

Short rests: The underground level is not safe for a short rest until the Guardian Beast (Room 2) is defeated. The beast patrols the corridor and will attack any group attempting to rest. If the party attempts a short rest before defeating the beast, roll for a random encounter: on a 1-3 on a d6, the beast finds them.

Thormvuld arrival pressure: If the party attempts a long rest anywhere in Gamma-7, Thormvuld's force will arrive before they finish. The party will be awakened by the sound of horses and shouted orders at the facility entrance.

Safe rooms post-Guardian Beast: Once the beast is dead, Room 2 (now just empty cages and a hoard) can be used for a short rest. The reinforced door provides some security.

Room 2 — Guardian Beast Lair

Map Layout:

- **Size:** 6x6 squares (30x30 ft), square room
- **Entry:** Single reinforced door from corridor (west/southwest wall). Thicker door than standard, scarred with deep claw marks.
- **Items to draw:**
  - ☐ Broken chain anchor point on north wall.
  - ☐ Gnawed bones scattered across floor.
  - ☐ Hoard pile in southeast corner (coins, cup, vials, gemstones).
  - ☐ Creature in center-east shadows — mark as "?" until revealed.
- **Terrain:** Confined. Cages and debris provide half cover (AC +2). Creature knows every hiding spot.
- **Lighting:** Dark. Creature has darkvision. Party needs light source.
- **Note:** Former containment vault — walls are reinforced stone.

Room 3 — Creature Pens

Map Layout:

- **Size:** 4x12 squares (20x60 ft), long rectangular corridor with cells along east wall
- **Entry:** Single door from main underground corridor (west wall, near north end)
- **Items to draw:**
  - ☐ 7 cells along east wall.
  - ☐ Cells 1-4 are smaller (2x2 squares each), doors open.
  - ☐ Cells 5-6 larger (3x3 squares each).
  - ☐ Skeletal remains in Cells 5-6 (manticore bones in 5, unidentifiable large bones in 6).
  - ☐ Cell 7 at south end (3x3 sq), door CLOSED, bolted from outside, viewing slot at eye level.
  - ☐ Small hoard pile visible inside Cell 7 (coins, belt buckle, hair ribbon).
- **Lighting:** Dark. No natural light.

Room 4 — Operating Theater

Map Layout:

- **Size:** 6x8 squares (30x40 ft), rectangular room
- **Entry:** Single door from main corridor (west wall, near center)
- **Items to draw:**
  - ☐ Tiered observation seating along north half (3 rows, rising 1 sq per row).
  - ☐ Central operating pit (2x2 sq in room center).
  - ☐ Iron table with restraints in pit.
  - ☐ Surgical instrument racks along south wall (scalpels, saws, forceps, needles).

    - ☐ Anatomical charts on east wall (wolves, manticores, griffons with crystal integration points marked).
    - ☐ Specimen cabinets with jars along west wall.
- **Lighting:** Dark. Shadowy.

Room 5 — Records Office

Map Layout:

- **Size:** 4x6 squares (20x30 ft), rectangular side room
- **Entry:** Collapsed tunnel (DC 20 Athletics (reduce by 2 for each person helping) to unearth), coming from Room 2
- **Items to draw:**
    - ☐ Filing cabinets along north and east walls (some overturned).
        - ☐ Sealed ViF letter (in filing cabinet).
    - ☐ Papers scattered across floor.
        - ☐ Research folder (among scattered papers).
        - ☐ Partial map fragment (tucked inside research folder).
    - ☐ Desk in southeast corner with chair, dead oil lamp, mug with dried residue, locked drawer
        - ☐ Locked drawer (DC 13 Sleight of Hand) under desk — 2 Potions of Healing
        - ☐ Subject Transfer Ledger (on desk)
    - ☐ Water damage in northeast corner from dome collapse
- **Lighting:** Dim — daylight filtering through water-damaged ceiling.
- **GM Notes:**
    - Thormvuld arrives at facility (enter Room 1) when party is in this room.

Room 6 — Burn Pit / Waste Disposal

Map Layout:

- **Size:** 3x4 squares (15x20 ft), small rectangular room
- **Entry points:**
    - ☐ (1) Door from main corridor at south end.
    - ☐ (2) Drainage tunnel entrance in east wall (Method C — partially rubble-filled).
- **Items to draw:**
    - ☐ Large iron furnace against north wall (cold, 3x2 sq).
    - ☐ Bone fragments visible in ash.
    - ☐ Ventilation shaft/chimney from furnace goes up (not accessible from ground floor).
    - ☐ Loose stone in furnace wall (DC 14 Investigation)
        - ☐ Hidden compartment with **oilcloth-wrapped journal - Elena Vance's**.
    - ☐ Rubble pile near drainage tunnel entrance.
- **Lighting:** Complete darkness. Party needs light source.
- **Note:** Very cramped if combat happens here. Drain tunnel is emergency escape route.

The Journal:

A junior researcher at Gamma-7, **Elena Vance**, kept a private journal. Last entry: day the facility was decommissioned.

Key facts from the journal:

- They're shutting Gamma-7 down, moving operations north
- Orders came from the Chief Architect himself - they're being consolidated
- All monster integration research is being folded into the "main project" (unnamed)
- She was ordered to destroy all remaining samples but couldn't do it
- Covenant overode access to Subject 242 - subject escaped
- She doesn't know what the Covenant is building, but she's afraid

This journal:

- Confirms the Flesh Architects were a ViF division
- Confirms Gamma-7 was decommissioned and consolidated into a larger project
- Names the "Chief Architect" (for the first time - a named figure)

Document Summary — Gamma-7 Records

A consolidated reference for the five key documents found in the facility.

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1. Elena Vance's Journal (Room 6 — Burn Pit)

Where: Hidden behind loose stone in furnace wall (DC 14 Investigation) *Writer:* Junior researcher assigned to Gamma-7

Key facts:

- Gamma-7 is being shut down — operations moving north
- Orders came from the **Chief Architect** himself — consolidation directive
- All monster integration research is being folded into the unnamed "main project"
- She was ordered to destroy all remaining samples but couldn't bring herself to do it
- Covenant overrode access to Subject 242 — subject escaped
- She doesn't know what the Covenant is building, but she's afraid

Confirms:

- The Flesh Architects were a ViF division (Three Curves appears throughout)
- Gamma-7 was decommissioned and consolidated into a larger project
- Names the "Chief Architect" (first named Flesh Architect figure)

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2. Sealed ViF Letter (Room 5 — Records Office, filing cabinet)

Where: Filing cabinet, north or east wall *Format:* Sealed envelope stamped with the **Three Curves** symbol *Language:* Undercommon *Sender:* "Arch-Liaison, Underdark Research Compact" *Recipient:* "Chief Researcher, Site Gamma-7"

Key facts:

- Discusses specimen transfer protocols between Underdark Division and Flesh Architects
- Details integrated physiology studies under ViF's unified research mandate

- Confirms Kaelyn's Drow captors were a **ViF division** — not Lolth agents
- Confirms Kaelyn was a coalition-wide specimen shared between divisions

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3. Research Folder (Room 5 — Records Office, scattered papers)

Where: Among papers scattered across the floor

Key facts:

- Contains monster integration research data from Gamma-7's operations
- References both **Project Genesis** and the **Catalyst Project** by name
- Notes on crystal integration trials — explains why the operating tables (Room 1) were built for non-humanoid creatures

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4. Partial Map Fragment (Room 5 — Records Office, inside research folder)

Where: Tucked inside the research folder

Key facts:

- Shows general direction of a larger facility **east-southeast** of Gamma-7
- Labels the destination as the "Primary Facility"
- No exact coordinates — directional only, enough to guide future travel

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5. Subject Transfer Ledger (Room 5 — Records Office, on desk)

Where: Desk in southeast corner

Key facts:

- Formal documentation of test subjects by number
- **Subject 242 (Zan):** Scheduled for transfer **TO** Gamma-7 **FROM** the Primary Facility
- Requesting agent: **Agent Korvus** — a trackable name
- Status: "DENIED — Covenant already requested — (UNFULFILLED — Subject escaped)"
- Proves Zan was **selected, catalogued, and processed** — not a random victim
- Confirms the **Catalyst Project** as the program that flagged his transfer

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8. ZAN'S REVEAL - SUBJECT 242

The core beat is in **Room 5 - Records Office**

What Zan learns concretely:

1. He was **Subject 242** in a formal, documented numbering system
2. He was **scheduled for transfer** to Gamma-7 from the Primary Facility - the Catalyst Project flagged him for Phase II work, but he escaped before the transfer
3. The name "Catalyst Project" appears in official documents - this was a real program with a real name

4. There is a primary facility somewhere else. Bigger. More important.

Emotional beat: Zan has spent 16 years believing he was a random victim. This proves he was *selected*. Identified. Catalogued. The paperwork of his suffering exists. And it proves the Flesh Architects are still out there - they just moved to a bigger facility.

Player-facing prompt (GM, to Zan's player): Facts to communicate - he's known for 16 years what they did, but this is the first time seeing it written down. His number, his classification, his transfer order - they had a system, a process, and he was processed. Ask: what does he do?

What Zan can do with this intel:

- The transfer order names the requesting agent: **Agent Korvus** - a name to track
- The partial map shows the general direction of the primary facility (east-southeast)

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9. KAELYN'S CONNECTION - VERITAS IN FRACTUM

The find: A sealed envelope stamped with the **Three Curves** symbol. Inside: a letter written in Undercommon, signed by the "*Arch-Liaison, Underdark Research Compact*" It is addressed to "Chief Researcher, Site Gamma-7" and discusses specimen transfer protocols and integrated physiology studies under ViF's unified research mandate.

Kaelyn's recognition (GM-facing - facts to convey to the player):

- She stared at that symbol on her cell wall for 20 years
- She assumed Drow - a House crest, a Lolthite rite - she was wrong
- The Drow researchers who held her weren't working for Lolth; they were a **division** of a continent-spanning coalition
- Her cell was marked because she was **ViF property** - a specimen in a shared research program (Underdark Division + Flesh Architects)
- She was never "just" a Drow prisoner - she was part of something much larger

Emotional Beat (GM-facing - facts to convey to the player)

- For 150 years she believed her mother imprisoned her purely out of cruelty and curiosity about her magical powers and crystal
- But the symbol tells her something else: her mother was not acting alone
- She was part of something larger - Kaelyn's suffering served a purpose she never knew existed
- Somewhere - Underdark archive, hidden vault, a paper with her name on it - her file still exists

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10. INTEL THREADS (Deployable During Session)

Seeds to weave into descriptions, NPC dialogue, or found documents as the session unfolds:

- **Next facility:** Primary ViF facility exists east-southeast (partial map coordinates). Catalyst Project and Project Genesis referenced there.
- **Agent Korvus:** Named requesting agent for Zan Subject 242 transfer. Trackable lead.
- **Chief Architect:** Named in Elena Vance journal. A named Flesh Architect figure.
- **Thormvuld scouts:** Reported near Gamma-7 in recent days. Searching for heist traces.

- **Monster army activity:** Supply caches positioned across the frontier. Goblin-written manifests found on patrols. Pushback timeline seen in one dispatch: "2 sunrises" — sooner than FX's intel suggests. Marginal note on hoarding behavior in the 7th cohort — a hint something is affecting the army's command structure.

11. THORMVULD ARRIVAL - FACTION PRESSURE

Timing

Thormvuld arrives **during the party's exploration of Gamma-7.**

Trigger: The party explores Room 5 and finds relevant documentation

The Arrival - facts to convey:

- First: vibration in the stone floor
- Then: sound of multiple horses approaching at a canter
- Voices and footsteps, muffled by distance and stone
- Then a sharp order shouted in Common: "Secure the perimeter. Two on the entrance. The rest with me - we're going in."

Thormvuld Force:

Member	Role
Lord Keylor Thormvuld (or a lieutenant)	Commander. Carries a torch and a sheathed rapier. Speaks with authority.
4 Veteran Guards	Human fighters, chainmail, swords and crossbows. Efficient, no-nonsense.
1 Arcane Advisor	Human wizard or warlock. Carries a satchel of documents and an Arcane Focus. Here to identify and retrieve specific documents.

Their objective:

- Burn the facility (destroy evidence)
- Recover any remaining documents
- Eliminate witnesses

They do NOT know the party is here yet. They're arriving expecting an empty facility they can clean up in a few hours.

What Thormvuld Does (If Unopposed)

1. Enter through the main door (hidden mechanism - they know how to open it)
2. Quickly sweep Room 1 (Main Hall) - veteran guards secure it
3. Head to Room 5 (Records Office) - the arcane advisor searches for specific documents, orders the rest burned
4. Descend to underground level - sweep Rooms 3-6 for remaining research materials, set charges
5. Set timed charges or oil fires throughout the facility
6. Depart within 45-60 minutes

The party, if hidden, can:

- Observe what Thormvuld prioritizes (understand their objectives)
- Intercept them before they reach a key room
- Steal back documents Thormvuld recovers
- Escape with what they've already found

If combat breaks out:

- Thormvuld guards are trained, disciplined, and use tactical formations
- The arcane advisor hangs back and controls the battlefield (crowd control spells)
- Lord Keylor (or the lieutenant) fights dueling-style - precise, targeted
- Thormvuld tries to capture one party member alive for interrogation rather than kill all

5. D8 TRAVEL TABLE - Frontier Travel

d8	Encounter
1	**Cache of Supplies.** Half-buried satchel: 2 Potions of Healing, 1 antitoxin, trail mix (2 days), silver ring (10 gp). Inscribed: "*For better days.*"
2	**Monster Army Patrol.** 2 hobgoblins + 3 goblins. Locked iron box with supply manifests + a Goblin-written dispatch in Goblin (Bardolemeu reads). Cache contents: 2 Potions of Healing, 1 Potion of Fire Breath, 30 gp in mixed coin, army rations (2 days). The dispatch mentions the pushback is planned in "2 sunrises" (sooner than FX's intel — tension). A marginal note on one manifest: "*Supply runners report the 7th cohort hoards everything now. Not distributing. Taking orders from something in the hills.*" — First hint of B-crystal hoarding behavior spreading through the monster army ranks. CR: Easy.
3	**Battlefield Remnants.** Pre-invasion skirmish site. Bones, rusted sword, helmet with bullet hole. Crystal-stained skeleton. No combat. Atmosphere.
4	**Encroaching Wilds.** Wrong vegetation: spiral thorns, vivid flowers, geometric roots. DC 13 Nature: mutated from airborne crystal dust. Cosmetic.
5	**Ambush from Above.** Manticore/young wyvern. Surprise dive, retreats at 50% HP. Lair: 3d10 gp, 1 Potion of Greater Healing, melted holy symbol.
6	**Watchtower Ruins.** Collapsed tower. Climb (DC 10) for a view. Logbook: "*The lights out there... they move like searching for something.*"
7	**Ongoing Battle.** Thormvuld caravan (3 wagons, 4 guards) vs monster army (1 ogre + 6 goblins). Party: help, slip past (DC 14), scavenge.
8	**Gemstone Vein.** Creek bed (Perception DC 12). DC 10 Mining: 2d4 rough gems (10 gp each). DC 12 Strength: decorative stone (15 gp).

12. RANDOM NPCs

NPC 1: Soren Vane - Human Male, Late 40s, Frontier Scavenger

Trait	Detail
Race	Human
Gender	Male
Age	Late 40s
Distinctive Feature	Missing left ear - a clean cut, old scar. Wears a brass earring on the remaining ear.

NPC 2: Mira Stonebrook - Half-Elf Female, Early 30s, Wandering Healer

Trait	Detail
Race	Half-Elf
Gender	Female
Age	Early 30s
Distinctive Feature	Her left hand is wrapped in clean white bandages - always. She never says why.

NPC 3: Grimbok "Grim" Ironhide - Dwarf Male, 62, Degenerate Prospector

Trait	Detail
Race	Dwarf
Gender	Male
Age	62
Distinctive Feature	So drunk he sways while standing still. Red-rimmed eyes. Flask always in hand.

NPC 4: Seraphine "Sera" Blackwood - Halfling Female, 26, Courier

Trait	Detail
Race	Halfling (ashen skin, short hair, golden eyes)
Gender	Female
Age	26
Distinctive Feature	A leather courier's satchel with a wax-sealed letter sticking out. She's fast - lightning-quick movements, restless.

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12. LOOT TABLES

12.1 Thormvuld Guard Loot (Post-Combat)

d6	Find
1	Healing Potion (standard) - each guard carries 1

d6	Find
2	2d10 gp in mixed coin
3	Thormvuld signet ring (worth 5 gp, or 20 gp to a fence who deals with noble-house memorabilia)
4	A sealed order (map to a Thormvuld supply cache in the frontier - future POI)
5	Masterwork dagger (non-magical, 25 gp)
6	Small pouch of diamond dust (50 gp value, material component for Revivify)

12.2 General Loot Table - Gamma-7 (Uncommon Items, Level 4 Party)

Roll 1d20 for each significant location searched:

d20	Item	Type	Notes
1-3	Nothing useful	-	Rusted, broken, decayed
4-5	1d4 - 10 gp in old coinage	Currency	Pre-invasion minting - worth more to collectors (double value in cities)
6	Small rough gemstone (10 gp)	Gem	Amethyst or garnet
7	Medium cut gemstone (25 gp)	Gem	Citrine or jade
8-9	Potion of Healing (standard)	Consumable	2d4+2 HP
10	Potion of Climbing	Consumable	1 hour, climbing speed
11	Scroll of *Cure Wounds* (1st level)	Consumable	Single use
12	Smokesticks (2)	Consumable	Obscures 10-ft radius for 1 round
13	Healer's Kit (10 uses)	Gear	Standard
14	Thieves' Tools (basic)	Gear	Standard
15	ViF signet ring	Trinket	Worth 15 gp. Bears the Three Curves symbol. Could be used as a bluff credential by anyone claiming to be a ViF operative.
16	A child's drawing, preserved in a frame	Trinket	A crayon drawing of a family - dated to before the invasion. Found in a desk drawer. No connection to the plot. Just humanity.
17	Vial of holy water (Aurelius-blessed)	Consumable	Against undead/fiends
18	A crystal shard (tiny, inert)	Trinket	No magical energy left. Warm to the touch. Hummed once. Now silent. A keepsake.

d20	Item	Type	Notes
19	Potion of Resistance (choose: fire, cold, or poison)	Consumable	10 minutes resistance
20	Potion of Invisibility	Consumable	Rare find - mark this as significant

12.3 Random Trinket Table - Setting Depth

For when the party searches a random drawer or cabinet and you want to toss them something small:

d6	Trinket
1	A broken pocket watch, stopped at 4:37. The glass is cracked.
2	A small leather coin pouch with a child's name stitched in: "Liam." Empty.
3	A dried flower pressed between two pages of an old logbook. Still faintly blue.
4	A single playing card - the Queen of Ravens. Worn at the edges.
5	A half-melted candle stamped with the Three Curves - ViF's symbol.
6	A pebble with a naturally occurring hole through the center. Frontier folklore says it wards against nightmares.

14. THORMVULD STAT BLOCKS (Quick Reference)

Thormvuld Veteran Guard

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil

Armor Class 16 (chainmail) **Hit Points** 45 (7d8+14) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Senses passive Perception 11 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 2 (450 XP)

Multiattack. The guard makes two longsword attacks.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8+3) slashing damage, or 9 (1d10+3) if wielded with two hands.

Heavy Crossbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, range 100/400 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d12+1) piercing damage.

Thormvuld Arcane Advisor

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil

Armor Class 12 **Hit Points** 32 (7d8+7) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Int +5, Wis +3 **Senses** passive Perception 11 **Languages** Common, Draconic **Challenge** 3 (700 XP)

Spellcasting. The advisor is a 5th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). It has the following wizard spells prepared:

Cantrips (at will): fire bolt, mage hand, minor illusion 1st level (4 slots): shield, magic missile, identify 2nd level (3 slots): misty step, web, suggestion

Lord Keylor Thormvuld (Lieutenant, Optional)

Medium humanoid (dwarf), lawful evil

Armor Class 17 (studded leather + parry) **Hit Points** 58 (9d8+18) **Speed** 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Con +4 **Skills** Acrobatics +6, Perception +4 **Senses** passive Perception 14 **Languages** Common, Dwarvish **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP)

Multiattack. Keylor makes two rapier attacks or one rapier and one dagger attack.

Rapier. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (1d8+4 + 2d6) piercing and poison damage.

Dagger. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d4+4) piercing damage.

Parry (Reaction). Keylor adds +3 to his AC against one melee attack that would hit him.

13. GUARDIAN BEAST STAT BLOCK

Crystal-Infused Guardian Beast (Gamma-7 Gatekeeper)

Large monstrosity (experiment), neutral evil

Armor Class 14 (natural armor). Crystal growths grant +2 AC against ranged attacks (effective 16 vs ranged). **Hit Points** 97 (13d10+26) **Speed** 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	12 (+1)	17 (+3)	4 (-3)	13 (+1)	6 (-2)

Saving Throws Str +7, Con +5 **Damage Resistances**: **bludgeoning, piercing** from *nonmagical attacks* **Condition Immunities** frightened, charmed **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11 **Languages** -- **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP)

Crystal-Infused Hide. Crystal growths across the beast's shoulders and skull grant +2 AC against ranged attacks.

Hoarding Instinct. The beast has disadvantage on Wisdom saving throws but cannot be persuaded or intimidated to leave its hoard.

Maddened Rampage. When reduced to 30 hit points or fewer, the beast enters a frenzy. It discharges a ***Crystal Shard Burst*** and makes one extra attack per round (no disadvantage). The frenzy lasts until the end of combat.

Multiattack. The beast makes two attacks: one with its claws and one with its bite.

Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8+5) slashing damage.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d10+5) piercing damage.

Crystal Shard Burst (Recharge 5-6). The beast flares its crystal growths, releasing a burst of arcane energy in a 15-foot radius. Creatures in range must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 18 (4d8) force damage on a failed save, or half as much on a successful one. After using this ability, the beast's crystal growths dim and it gains one level of exhaustion (reducing speed by 10 ft.) until the end of its next turn.